Nora Patel

Platform engineer · reliable services and thoughtful teamwork

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Experience

Lead platform engineer, Orchard Systems

Apr 2022 – present

A fictional team building scheduling and reporting tools for community organisations. I guide a small platform group supporting product engineers and operations colleagues.

- Designed a shared deployment process with clear ownership and recovery steps. Teams can release routine changes without waiting for a specialist to be available.
- Replaced a fragile overnight import with resumable jobs and visible progress. Support staff can identify incomplete work and restart only the affected records.
- Worked with service owners to define useful reliability goals. Reports connect technical failures to the tasks people were trying to complete.
- Led a gradual migration from a shared database to explicit service interfaces, keeping existing integrations working throughout the transition.
- Created practical incident exercises using familiar failure scenarios. Every exercise ends with a small improvement to a runbook, alert or recovery tool.
- Mentored engineers through design reviews and production investigations, with an emphasis on explaining decisions and asking useful questions.

Senior software engineer, Canopy Cooperative

Feb 2019 – Mar 2022

Built internal services for a fictional cooperative delivering supplies to local shops. Paired with dispatchers and customer support to improve daily operations.

- Built an availability service that combined warehouse updates with planned deliveries. Clear error messages made incomplete or delayed updates visible to staff.
- Added contract tests around external integrations so changes could be deployed gradually, with evidence that existing clients still behaved correctly.
- Simplified the order correction workflow after observing support calls. Staff could review the history of a change before updating an order.
- Introduced lightweight architecture notes describing constraints and tradeoffs. New colleagues used them to understand why existing services behaved as they did.
- Improved local development scripts and reference datasets, helping engineers reproduce common support issues without access to customer records.

Software engineer, Meadow Instruments

July 2016 – Jan 2019

Developed a fictional laboratory booking product with a small team of engineers, researchers and support specialists.

- Implemented reservation rules that accounted for equipment maintenance, preparation time and competing requests for the same resources.
- Added audit history and read-only exports for laboratory coordinators. Reports explained changes without exposing unnecessary participant information.

Education

MSc, Software Systems

Northbridge Institute of Technology

Sept 2014 – June 2016

- Research project on understandable incident reports for teams maintaining distributed services.

BSc, Computer Science

Alder College

Sept 2011 – June 2014

- Group project building accessible booking tools with local community organisations.

Toolbox

Engineering

Python
Go
PostgreSQL
HTTP APIs
Event processing
Data modelling
Contract testing

Reliability

Service objectives
Incident response
Recovery exercises
Capacity planning
Alert design
Runbook writing
Failure analysis

Languages

English: Native

French: Working proficiency

- Turned recurring support questions into regression tests and short troubleshooting guides that colleagues could use during a busy day.
- Worked with researchers to check keyboard access, validation messages and the order of fields in the booking form.

Skills

Collaboration
Design reviews
Pair programming
Knowledge sharing

Delivery
Small batch releases
Migration planning
Feature flags
Deployment pipelines
Rollback procedures
Progress reporting
Incremental rollout

Leadership
Patient mentoring
Shared ownership
Career conversations